

TOWN MANAGER

To the Residents and Businesses of the Town of Ware:

This past year of 2022 was one of continued progress and planning. Based on the spirit and work of leaders, residents, businesses and agencies, there is a lot to look forward to in coming years. Progress proceeds at different paces, but progress is being made in all areas of town – growth, economic development, health and services, infrastructure, to name a few.

Thank you to Town Meeting, the Selectboard and the Finance Committee, who along with the Town's Finance team have increased the Town's fiscal stability and reserves. With conservative budget oversight and investments in capital, the town was able to hold back on budget spending to save taxpayers over \$400,000. This reduction was permanently formalized by residents' adoption of an override. The Stabilization and reserve funds are in a strong position as revenues in 2021 and 2022 made it possible to increase savings.

The closure of Mary Lane center moves forward. As Baystate Health moves operations to Palmer, the Town received a grant to hire architects and planners to assist the Town with identifying the best future re-use of the site. This work will continue in 2023. It is an opportunity for the Town for future growth. Other anticipated growth will come from the commercial zoning amendment on Palmer Road, the growing occupancy at Cedarbrook, and the downtown efforts of businesses and the Ware Business and Civic Association. The Selectboard has approved agreements with Cannabis retail and cultivation facilities as well as proposed growth of construction waste removal. These payments assist the ability of the Town in providing services.

Working with the towns of Palmer and Monson, an upgraded Animal Control Shelter was established. Under the leadership of the Senior Center, Ware continues to expand services and plans to improve its Age and Dementia Friendly status. The Selectboard authorized the use of Federal American Rescue Plan (ARPA) funds for a screen at the wastewater plant and to fund a Grants Coordinator for the Town. The coordinator position has greatly paid off with grants received for climate change, hazard mitigation, economic planning, sidewalk improvements on Church Street, pedestrian, and road improvements on West Street, planning for reuse of Mary Lane and restoration of the Reed pool. Seventeen businesses were approved for façade and sign improvements with grant funds.

Thank you to all groups and individual volunteers and those who serve on committees, all who inspired numerous events in town. Events improve the town, bring visitors and add to the quality of life in Ware. Events include the Town Clean Up on Earth Day, Workshop13's Rock the Park and cultural happenings, Halloween and Ware Flair drive throughs, rail trail work, fireworks, a new carnival, holiday youth activity, pickleball, Eagle Scout projects, Domestic Violence Awareness Walk, parades, and youth sports. So many, many volunteers who gave time to make these events happen. Thank you to all who work to show Ware Cares.

Thank you to recent retiree Officer LuAn Czapla for many years of service.

With fond memories and deep gratitude for years of DPW service, we will miss Gibby.

2022 was another good year of progress for the Town of Ware. There is more to come. This is a beautiful town with caring people that will draw investment. Positive outlook and outcome are daily tasks for all of us. Thank you for your help.

Thank you for the opportunity to serve the Town and its residents.

Stuart Beckley, Town Manager

ANNUAL TOWN ELECTION – APRIL 11, 2022

In accordance with the accompany warrant, the Inhabitants of the Town of Ware, qualified to vote in the elections of the town, Precincts A, B & C, met at the Ware Town Hall, 126 Main Street on Monday, April 11, 2022, at seven o'clock in the forenoon. The warrant calling the town election having previously been posted, according to the by of the town, met all legal requirements.

Cards of Instructions for Voters, Cards of Penalties of Corrupt Practices at the Elections, Specimen Ballots, etc. having previously been posted in the Town Hall outside the voting rails, the ballot boxes were set at naught. The polls were declared open by the Warden George Staiti.

The polls closed at eight o'clock. The total ballots cast were Three Hundred Eighty (380). The election results are as follows for the offices appearing on the ballot:

	<u>Precinct A</u>	<u>Precinct B</u>	<u>Precinct C</u>	<u>Total</u>
SELECTMEN FOR THREE YEARS – Vote for One				
Joshua Adam Kusnierz	89	116	120	325
Write Instructions	8	3	6	17
Blanks	<u>10</u>	<u>13</u>	<u>15</u>	<u>38</u>
Total	107	132	141	380

SCHOOL COMMITTEE FOR THREE YEARS – Vote for Two

Christopher T. Desjardins	84	110	115	309
Brian P. Winslow	65	82	94	241
Write Ins	0	0	0	0
Blanks	<u>65</u>	<u>72</u>	<u>73</u>	<u>210</u>
Total	214	264	282	760

BOARD OF ASSESSORS FOR THREE YEARS – Vote for One

Gerald Francis Fountain, Jr.	83	113	119	315
Write Ins	0	0	1	1
Blanks	<u>24</u>	<u>19</u>	<u>21</u>	<u>64</u>
Total	107	132	141	380

BOARD OF HEALTH FOR THREE YEARS – Vote for One

Write Ins:				
Jennifer McMartin	24	24	30	78
All others (less than 5 votes each)	6	5	10	21
Blanks	<u>77</u>	<u>103</u>	<u>101</u>	<u>281</u>
Total	107	132	141	380

PARK COMMISSIONER FOR THREE YEARS – Vote for One

Ryan E. Mulligan	82	113	123	318
Write Ins	1	1	1	3
Blanks	<u>24</u>	<u>18</u>	<u>17</u>	<u>59</u>
Total	107	132	141	380

CEMETERY COMMISSIONER FOR THREE YEARS – Vote for One

Write Ins:				
Paul Harper	9	22	11	42
All others (less than 5 votes each)	7	1	7	15
Blanks	<u>91</u>	<u>109</u>	<u>123</u>	<u>323</u>
Total	107	132	141	380

PLANNING BOARD FOR FIVE YEARS – Vote for One

Write Ins:				
Nancy Talbot	3	8	1	12
All others (less than 5 votes each)	9	4	8	21
Blanks	<u>95</u>	<u>120</u>	<u>132</u>	<u>347</u>
Total	107	132	141	380

A true copy attest: Nancy J. Talbot
Town Clerk, Ware